

Divorce Teacher – Follow-Up – Survey

28.2.2024 – 16.5.2024

Welcome

1. Welcome back!

You recently took part in the first survey as part of the **Family Life study** on the topic of **family life, long-term career and life planning, and financial security**.

Thank you for your effort and time, we greatly appreciate your answers and feedback. Today we ask you to take part in this **short follow-up survey**.

Today's survey will last approximately **10-15 minutes**. Among all participants who fully complete the survey, we will give away **3 vouchers** to Digitec-Galaxus, each worth **300 CHF**.

If you have any questions or concerns about this study, please contact our research team (UZH Department of Economics, Schönberggasse 1 8001 Zurich) at family@econ.uzh.ch.

Best regards

Your research team

Feelings

We would like to start by asking you a few questions about your satisfaction in various areas of your life.

2. How satisfied are you with your **current situation**, in terms of ...

[Randomized order]

- ... the **quality of time** spent with your family?
- ... your partnership?
- (If Children not = 0 in baseline)... your friends' and family's **understanding** of the challenges you face as a mother?
- ... the current **division of household [(if child not=0)and childcare] activities** with your partner?
- ... the sense of **purpose** you feel in your job?

Very dissatisfied; Dissatisfied; Neither nor; Satisfied; Very satisfied

3. Now, we would like to know how **you felt in the last month**. In the **last month**, how often have you had the **feeling** ...

[Randomized order]

- ... of being **nervous** or stressed?
- ... that **things were going your way**?
- ... that you **can't cope** with all the things you have to do?
- ... that you were **on top of things**?

Rarely; Sometimes; Often

4. At this moment, how do you feel when **thinking** about the **future**? *Please select all feelings that apply.* [Multiple answers are possible]
[Randomized order; “None of the above” always last]

Angry; Anxious; Hopeful; Discouraged; Happy; Motivated; None of the above

Couple Satisfaction

5. Please indicate how **happy** you are in your **relationship** with your partner.

Very unhappy; Rather unhappy; Neither nor; Rather happy; Very happy

6. For each of the following scales, please select the adjective that best describes **how you perceive your relationship**. *Please answer according to your first spontaneous impression.*

[Randomized order]

- Interesting – Boring
- Bad – Good
- Fulfilling – Unsatisfactory
- Robust – Fragile
- Discouraging – Hopeful
- Pleasant – Repulsive

[Scale 1(1)5]

Measures

7. In our **last survey** you watched a short **information video**. What was the topic of the video you saw?

[Randomized order, «I do not know» always last]

Financial risks in the event of a divorce; Seeking help for psychological problems; Influence of digital media on child development; I don't know.

8. In the next step, we would like to know whether, since the last survey, you have engaged with the topic of the video shown.

Have you **spoken** to any of the following people about the **topic** of the survey **video**? *Please select all that apply.* [Multiple answers are possible]

Partner; Friends; Colleagues; Family; Somebody else not listed above, please specify: [Inline Textbox]; Nobody

9. (If «Partner» at 8) You indicated that you discussed the content of the video with **your partner**. Which **aspects** did you discuss? *Please select all aspects that apply.*

Summary of contents; My participation in the study; What my partner thinks about this topic; My criticism of the video; Significance of the topic for society; Significance of the topic for my own situation; Significance of the topic for our household; Significance of the topic for people we are close to; Others, please specify: [Inline textbox]

10. (If not «Partner» and not “Nobody” at 8) You indicated that you discussed the content of the video with **somebody**. Which **aspects** did you discuss? *Please select all aspects that apply.*
[Multiple answers are possible]

*Summary of contents; My participation in the study; What my interlocutor thinks about this topic; My **criticism** of the video; Significance of the topic for **society**; Significance of the topic for my **own situation**; Significance of the topic for the situation of **my conversation partner**; Significance of the topic for **people** we are **close to**; Others, please specify: [Inline textbox]*

Conversations

11. (Partner if partner at 8, someone if "nobody" at 8, else: your conversation partner) How often has the topic of the video come up in conversations with [your partner/your conversation partner/someone] in the last two months?

Never; 1 time; 2-3 times; More than 3 times

12. (If not «Never» at 11) How would you describe the **character of [the conversation(s)]**? *Please select all adjectives that apply.* [Multiple answers are possible.]

[Randomized order, «Other» always last]

Unpleasant; Difficult; Tense; Hot-tempered; Neutral; Pleasant; Lively; Inspirational/Motivating; Purposeful; Emotional; Intense; Other [Inline Textbox]

13. (If not «Never» at 11) How **satisfied** are you with how **[the conversation(s)]** went?

Very unsatisfied; Rather unsatisfied; Neither nor; Rather satisfied; Very satisfied

14. (If not «Never» at 11) Would you say that any **specific actions** or steps emerged from the conversation?

No; Yes, please indicate [Open Text]

15. (If not «Partner» at 8) Why have you **not** discussed the content of the video with **your partner**? *Please select all that apply.* [Multiple answers are possible]

[Randomized order, «Other» always last]

*I did **not** find the topic **relevant** to my partner.; I had **no desire** to discuss this topic with him.; I haven't found the **right moment**; I **didn't feel comfortable** bringing up this topic.; I didn't know **how to bring up** the topic.; Other, please indicate: [Inline Textbox]*

Martial Stability

We would like to understand whether any of the following topics have arisen concerning your relationship in the last two months.

16. In the last two months, have you had the thought that your **relationship** might be **in trouble**?

Never; Rarely; Sometimes; Often; Very often

17. In the last two months, have you thought about a **breakup or divorce**?

Never; Rarely; Sometimes; Often; Very often

18. In the past two months, have you discussed the **possibility of your own divorce or separation** with someone close to you?

No; Yes

Interest in Information

19. We have almost reached the end of the survey. On the next page, you can choose between **two short excerpts of newspaper articles**. Please read the selected excerpt and describe in two to three sentences what you think the main message is. *Reading the article takes about 3 minutes. We are also giving away an additional Galaxus voucher worth CHF 100 among all the people who answer at least one sentence. Simply press continue when you have finished reading.* Which article would you like to read?

***Even high earners can only buy a house in peripheral regions;
Safe haven? Marriage is no longer a life insurance for women***

20. (If «Safe haven? Marriage is no longer a life insurance for women» at 19) **Marriage is no longer a life insurance for women; With a series of remarkable judgments, the Federal Court is ushering in a new era in family law**
Kathrin Alder (NZZ)

(translated)First, the Federal Court repealed the so-called “45 rule”: If a spouse was not working during the marriage and was at least 45 years old at the time of the divorce, the court no longer expected them to return to work after divorce. In the vast majority of cases, this affected women who had given up their original jobs to take care of children. The Federal Court states that the “Rule of 45” is not a “presumption made or contemplated by the legislature,” but is based on case law that has undergone a “change in meaning.” In its absoluteness, it is too rigid and often no longer does justice to actual circumstances. According to the judges in Lausanne (only men were involved in the relevant judgments), it must now be fundamentally assumed that resuming work is reasonable – if there exists any possibility at all and there are no “hindrances”, such as young children. Nursing staff, for example, are currently in high demand, while in the IT sector it is much more difficult to regain a professional footing after a long absence.

The new divorce law postulates the principle of self-sufficiency: If a woman is healthy, has an education, perhaps even further training, speaks the local language, is not close to retirement and the job market allows it, she should earn her own money, said the judges in Lausanne. Anyone who refuses to make reasonable efforts to reintegrate into work life must have a fictitious income credited to them and thus receive less maintenance. In the specific judgment, the Federal Court concluded that the woman had made too little effort to become economically independent after the divorce – even though it was clear early on that the shared household would be dissolved. The woman was 44 at the time of the separation and 50 at the time of the divorce.

The Federal Court's case law particularly strengthens “egalitarian” relationships, i.e. those in which men and women share paid work, household duties, and childcare. Reality shows, however, that this family model is still in the minority. According to the Federal Statistical Office, the “traditional” model is still the most widespread. In families with children aged 0 to 12, 70 to 73 percent of men work full-time, while women do not work at all or work part-time – most often with a maximum workload of 50 percent. This model can be freely chosen by a couple. However, the general conditions are often also likely to play a role: a tax system that puts married couples at a disadvantage when it comes to the second income, expensive

external childcare or men who cannot or do not want to work part-time. The Federal Court's call to stay tuned is not just aimed at women but also at politics. Politicians are now required to improve the legal framework so that women can take care of themselves at any time – even after a separation or divorce.

21. (If «Even high earners can only buy a house in peripheral regions» at 19) **Even high earners can only buy a house in peripheral regions**

Maren Meyer (Tages-Anzeiger)

Dream of owning your own home

They are between 30 and 50 years old, live as a couple and earn 150,000 francs: Yet very few people can afford a house. In certain cantons it is less than five percent.

A terraced house with five and a half rooms and 130 square meters, built in 1987, is currently for sale in the Zug municipality of Cham. The price: 1.72 million francs. If you want to buy a house with a mortgage and 20 percent equity, you should earn around 300,000 francs gross annually. That's what the banks' affordability rule says.

This means: Apart from equity, the buyers must be able to bear additional costs. This includes the fictitious interest rate of around 5 percent that is applied when granting a mortgage, the monthly amortization costs of the mortgage, and additional costs incurred for the property.

According to the rule of thumb, this amount should not exceed one-third of the gross wage. For those who earn, for example, 150,000 francs, the dream of owning a house in the canton of Zug is dashed.

In its latest real estate monitoring, the real estate consulting firm Wüest Partner has calculated how few households can still afford to buy a home in Switzerland and how big the regional differences are between the affordable price and the asking price. To do this, she analyzed the group of 30 to 50-year-olds who live in two-person households and have a combined average income of around 150,000 francs - they represent the upper Swiss middle class. The average disposable household income is 81,468 francs per year.

Gap between affordability and asking price

The group of 30 to 50 year olds is relevant because surveys show that they have the greatest desire to own their own home: 52 percent of 30- to 40-year-olds say yes to the idea of purchasing a home. Among 40- to 50-year-olds, it is 41 percent. Overall, 40 percent of 30- to 50-year-olds say no to buying a house – but only because they don't have the financial means. However, the desire exists.

The gap between the asking price of a property and affordability is sometimes large: for 79 percent of the households mentioned, the average market prices in the single-family home segment are not affordable. The regional differences are large: In the cantons of Glarus and Jura, single-family homes are affordable for an average household budget – 58 percent and 71 percent of the households in question can afford to buy a house. In the cantons of Geneva, Zug and Schwyz, however, the offer price is at least 50 percent above the affordable price. Here, less than 5 percent of households aged 30 to 50 can buy a house.

The situation is similar in the tourist regions in Graubünden: demand is high, supply is small – and prices are becoming more unreachable for the buyers in question. In the cantons of Zurich, Lucerne and Basel-Stadt, the asking prices for single-family homes are also at least 40 percent above the affordable price.

22. Please state here - in two to three sentences - what you think the **main message of the article** is. *There is no right or wrong here. We just want to understand what you think is relevant.*

[Essay Textbox]

Feedback

23. We have now reached the end of the survey. Do you have any **feedback or additional comments** you would like to share with us?

[Essay Textbox]

24. END OF SURVEY Thank you for taking part in this survey. Your answer has been recorded.